Léo Picard, PhD

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Research

Interests

- Public policy and sustainable development
- The EU Emissions Trading System
- Emotional appeals in US politics and media

Publications

- Picard, L., & Stammbach, D. (2026). *"Figurative and Literal Language in US Governor Speeches"*. **Swiss Journal of Economics and Statistics**, 162(1), 9.
- Pinna, M., Picard, L., & Goessmann, C. (2022). *"Cable News and COVID-19 Vaccine Uptake"*. **Scientific Reports**, 12(1), 1-7.

Working papers

- *"Does Emission Trading Deliver? Microdata Evidence on Abatement, Trading, and Innovation"*, with Beat Hintermann, Maja Žarković and Corrado Di Maria.
- *"Cost Pass-Through, Productivity, and Climate Policy in the German Manufacturing Sector"*, with Beat Hintermann, Maja Žarković, Corrado Di Maria and Ulrich J. Wagner.
- *"When Employment Sours, Do Elections Turn Bitter?"*, single-authored.

Seminars and presentations

2026: Digital Humanities Lab (University of Basel); Arbeitstreffen zu umweltökonomischen Analysen mit Amtlichen Firmendaten für Deutschland (ZEW Mannheim).

2025: Economics Lunch (University of Basel); Research Network Sustainable Future (University of Basel); 10th Monash-Paris-Warwick-Zürich-CEPR Text-As-Data Workshop (online); Advisory Political Economics group (Stockholm University); 3rd Swiss workshop on Environmental, Resource and Energy Economics (SEREE, University of Lucerne).

2024: Summer School in Law, Business and Economic Policy (Georgetown University); Ausschluss für Umwelt- und Ressourcenökonomie (AURÖ Nachwuchsworkshop, Karlsruhe); Political Science seminar on the US 2024 presidential election (invited guest speaker, University of Basel); Monte Verità Conference on Sustainable Resource Use and Economic Dynamics (SURED, Ascona); 29th Annual Conference of the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (EAERE, KU Leuven); Public Opinion and Science Communication (invited guest speaker, University of Basel).

2023: EAERE-ETH European Winter School 2023 (Ascona); University Paris Dauphine-PSL Public Governance working group (online); Text-as-Data Political Science reading group (online); 28th Annual Conference of the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (EAERE, Cyprus); Fünftes Arbeitstreffen zu umweltökonomischen Analysen mit Amtlichen Firmendaten für Deutschland (ZEW Mannheim); 4th Student Chapter Workshop of the Swiss Association for Energy Economics (SAEE, Zürich).

2022: 10th Mannheim Conference on Energy and the Environment (ZEW Mannheim); Economics Lunch (University of Basel); Verein für Sozialpolitik ("Big Data in Economics", University of Basel).

Relevant work experience

Research

- Research Fellow, University of Basel *Since Sep. 2026*
- Research Associate, University of Basel *Mar. 2026 – Aug. 2026*
- PhD Candidate and Assistant to Dr. Beat Hintermann, Univ. of Basel *Sep. 2021 – Feb. 2026*
- Doctoral Research Affiliate, ETH Zürich *Sep. 2021 – Aug. 2026*
- Scientific Assistant to Dr. Elliott Ash, ETH Zürich *Feb. 2020 – Aug. 2021*
- Intern, Research and Policy Analysis, UNCTAD, Geneva *Aug. 2019 – Jan. 2020*
- Part-time Research Assistant, University of Lausanne (HEC) *Feb. 2018 – Aug. 2019*

Teaching assistance

University of Basel

- Public Economics (M.Sc.) *2024 – 2025*
- Introduction to Python Programming (all levels) *2023 – 2026*
- Seminars in Public and Environmental Economics (MSc, BSc in German) *2022 – 2026*
- Economics of Public Policy (M.Sc.) *2021 – 2026*

ETH Zürich

- Big Data for Public Policy (M.Sc.) *2020*

University of Lausanne (HEC)

- Statistics and Applied Econometrics: Introduction (BSc, in French) *2019*

Academic service

2024: Referee for Resource and Energy Economics.

Education

University of Lausanne (HEC)

Doctor of Science (PhD) in Economics *Sep. 2021 – Jan. 2026*

- January 2026: successful defense of doctoral thesis, grade achieved: 5.7/6
- Fall 2025: Research exchange at Stockholm University (Sweden)

Master of Science (MSc) in Economics *Sep. 2017 – Jul. 2019*

- Fall 2018: Exchange semester at the University of Mannheim (Germany)

Bachelor of Science (BSc) in Economics *Sep. 2013 – Jul. 2017*

Other skills

Programming

General: Python, Bash
Statistics: Stata, R
Database management: SQL
Typesetting: LaTeX, Markdown
DevOps: Linux, SSH, Git, Docker
Frontend: HTML, CSS, Javascript

Languages

French: mother tongue
English: proficient
German: intermediate (B2)

References

Dr. Prof. Beat Hintermann
Full Professor of Economics
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Dr. Prof. Elliott Ash
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